

Common Problems & Escalations

You don't need to know **why** something is wrong. You need to know what to do.

 **STOP** → **DOCUMENT** → **ESCALATE** **Stop:** take no outside action on it. **Document:** save the emails/files; write one sentence on what's wrong. **Escalate:** send it to your manager the same day.

Situation	Your action
Contract says one amount, an email says another	 Escalate
Two documents or emails conflict on any term	 Do not choose. Escalate
Publishing says "25%" but not whether it's each or total	 Ask (Email 08); conflicting answers → 
A new producer, writer, or collaborator shows up	 Escalate
A sample or interpolation is mentioned	 Escalate
Co-producer's team won't confirm the split	Follow-up clock →  after the final follow-up
Agreement has a blank or "to be provided separately" page	 Escalate
Name misspelled on any document	Ask the sender to correct it; affects payment or LOD → 
Someone asks the producer to sign before the artist's LOD is in	 Escalate. Keep the hold.
LOD requested but missing	Email 03 → follow-up clock
Signed LOD but no certificate	Email 03 (ask for the certificate)
LOD payee or % doesn't match the agreement	 Escalate
Producer signed, but label/artist hasn't	Email 01 / 04 → follow-up clock
Not sure whether the agreement is final	 Escalate
Contract version changed	Save the new version (never overwrite) and recheck card 04 Part A
Vendor form rejected	Save the rejection; fix only what they named, on the form they sent
Payment requested but not confirmed	Email 02 → follow-up clock
"OK to pay" / PO issued	Mark PAYMENT PENDING, not paid
Amount paid ≠ invoice	 Escalate
Two payment routes, or a third party asks to be paid	 Escalate
Anyone asks you for bank information	 Escalate. Never send it
Label asks you to change or agree to deal terms	 Escalate
Anyone asks you to sign anything	 Escalate. You never sign
Release date unknown	Research + Email 05; record UNKNOWN until proven
Release ≤10 business days away with anything open	 Escalate the same day

Situation	Your action
© 2026 Keyman Publishing, LLC - Licensed to Vox Nova, LLC - Internal use only - not legal advice v1.0 - 2026-09-30 Song came out before paperwork was done	Mark RELEASED WITH OUTSTANDING ITEMS + 🚩
No reply after the final follow-up	🚩 Escalate
Terms or ownership disputed	🚩 Escalate. Don't argue

Escalation note (copy this)

Placement: KM-____ - [Artist] - [Song]
Problem: (one sentence)
Evidence: (file names)
Deadline: (release date / promised date)
Decision needed by: ____-__-__

No answer in 2 business days → resend, marked "second request."